

SPARK

A methodology for AI-augmented decision-making

Speculate · Plan · Assess · Rank · Kickoff

Most teams collapse the journey from possibility to execution into a blur of meetings and gut calls. SPARK separates the work into five distinct stages, each matched to a specific mode of thinking and a specific kind of AI assistance. The result is a deliberate, defensible path from open-ended question to committed build — without losing the ambition of the original brief.

S Speculate

Diverge widely. Generate possibilities without filtering, judging, or scoping. **AI's role:** expand the option space using context from connected tools — past projects, market signals, prior decisions — and surface adjacent ideas the team would not reach on its own.

P Plan

Sketch the shape of each promising candidate. Just enough detail to understand its scope, dependencies, and resource demands. **AI's role:** draft lightweight specifications, locate analogous prior work, and identify likely risks before they cost anything.

A Assess

Confront each candidate with reality: budget, capacity, calendar, technical readiness, strategic fit. **AI's role:** pull live data from connected systems, surface conflicts, and flag the missing information that would otherwise emerge late.

R Rank

Order the candidates. Force the trade-offs out into the open. **AI's role:** model alternative weightings, surface the cost of each choice, and draft the rationale so the decision can be defended later.

K Kickoff

Commit. Move the top candidate(s) into build mode with owners, milestones, and a working feedback loop. **AI's role:** scaffold the work plan, set up tracking, and schedule follow-ups across connected systems so momentum doesn't depend on memory.

Why SPARK works

- Each stage names a distinct mode of thinking, so teams know what is being asked of them.
- AI's contribution differs by stage; the methodology tells you which kind of help to invoke.
- Connected tools turn AI from a generic brainstormer into a context-aware partner.
- Ranking is treated as a commitment, not a vote — feasibility wins arguments, not enthusiasm.

SPARK · An AI-augmented methodology for moving from possibility to practice